

Hats become a statement accessory

Fur trim on shawl collar

Double ring of fur on sleeve adds luxury

Revival In the late 1940s, and into the 1950s, designers echoed the shape of the redingote, or frock coat, of the 18th and 19th centuries. The new style was form-fitting with a nipped-in waist, long flared skirt, and padded hips.

Peplum (ruffle)

1948

More fabric needed for very full cut

Wide shawl collar

Broad tie belt

1961

Wraparound style

Status symbol This fur coat from the early 1960s has a fuller cocoon shape with a broad shawl collar and wide tie belt. Many women dreamed of owning a fur coat because it symbolized glamour, femininity, and success.

Small, neat collar

Bracelet sleeves

1962

Flared hemline balances narrow shoulder

Leopard spots Animal prints were in vogue for the well-dressed woman of the era. Designers favoured real leopard for elegant clothes and accessories. Here, the thick pile of the skin lends structure to Paulene Trigère's banded swing coat.

Collar in astrakhan (lamb skin)

Large black buttons complement collar

1950

Smock-like cut

Loose lines A swing coat allows for fuller styles worn underneath – ideal for wearing over the big skirts of the 1950s. Unstructured cuts like this one use decorative touches to add punch.

JACQUELINE KENNEDY

At the beginning of the 1960s Jacqueline Kennedy, stylish wife of US President John F. Kennedy, was a significant influence on fashion. Her neat, youthful appearance made her a role model for women who rejected some of the more radical clothes of those years. The first lady favoured dress and coat ensembles for daywear, usually worn with matching hat, handbag, and shoes, and often all in shades of white or a single colour. American designer Oleg Cassini created Mrs Kennedy's White House wardrobe. His coats characteristically featured straight lines, a mandarin or stand-up collar, deep patch pockets, large self-cover buttons, bracelet-length sleeves, and a hem finishing just below the knee.

Jacqueline Kennedy: style icon